

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. Please include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

implication, and increasing the price beyond Rs 125 is a risky preposition. Even now, many of our readers feel Rs 125 is expensive.

Putting a "Copy to" button in our CD/DVD is quite possible, but we have to evaluate how useful that function would be.

Thanks for your mail... and keep the feedback mails coming in!

— Executive Editor

Accidental Reader

Dear Sir,

I first read an issue of *Digit* in 2004 when I was travelling from Ranchi to Patna... someone had forgotten the magazine on the train.

It greatly charged me with joy when I got the relevant answer of something about my computer debugging, which was making my life hell before that. Since then I've been a regular reader, as it helps me in becoming the system administrator in a small office. I don't know how the people like you, have carried such a tough job to make us, the laymen, the learners of computers, in a country where still more than half the population is struggling for their daily bread without caring for the importance of the information technology era. Great job done, sir.

Abhishek Choudhary
Ranchi

We're happy to have helped you in some way, Abhishek—small or big. It is indeed our agenda to make more and more people computer-literate—in small and big ways.

— Executive Editor

Digit Before All

I am a Hutch employee working as a computer operator (backend support) in Moradabad. Last month I had a shortage of money, and had two options—either recharge my mobile or purchase *Digit*; I selected to purchase *Digit*. This is how important *Digit* is to me. The *Fast Track* to the student's Web was a good one, and Excel 2007 is best for me to help me in my work because I mostly work with Excel. Waiting for the sixth anniversary wonder!

Manoj Tiwari
Moradabad

Dear Manoj,
I'm sure you'll like our sixth anniversary special—do write in after you've read it! Also, I'd like to express the sheer joy of receiving a mail that says someone prefers *Digit* over talk-time! We put in a lot of effort into our

magazine, and we love it when we are adequately appreciated. Thanks for reaching out to us.

— Executive Editor

Demands

I am a regular reader of your magazine, but this is the first time I am writing to you. I have a few suggestions to make:

Please use a dual-layered DVD.

- Have a *Fast Track* to 3D animation, Java, DBMS, OOP, IMAX, etc.
- If this is not possible, then at least get some e-books on these topics in your DVD.
- Have more movies and game videos (but not old movies)
- Include more games and add some full versions.
- Increase "Take A Crack"-like sections.
- Reduce loads of product reviews and instead give articles about robotics, AI, Web 2.0 & 3.0, etc.
- Give Madriva One live distro.
- Finally, as Sun provides its free DVD set containing Solaris 10 and Java Development Kit, kindly give it in some issue.

Hope you will pay heed to all my demands and fulfil them.

B Vaibhav
Via e-mail

Thanks for the suggestions, Vaibhav. I'll address them: regarding the magazine, we try our best to look at what the majority of our readers want, and our magazine content reflects that. Regarding the *Fast Track*, yes, we have one each month, so we'll to topics in programming and more.

Coming to the DVD, we'll include more games when possible; it's currently not. As for *more* movie and game videos, we also need to include software, so it's really not possible. Regarding the Mandriva One live distro, we've provided Ubuntu this time—we're sure you'll love it!

Solaris and the JDK... perhaps sometime. But the great thing about the DVD is, we're going dual-layer from now on!

— Executive Editor

ERRATA

The price of XBOX 360 was erroneously misquoted in our May 2007 issue. The correct price is: Core system - Rs. 19,990/- and Premium system - Rs. 27,750/- (including taxes). It's the taxes that got us into a fix. Inconvenience to whomsoever concerned is regretted.

Bravo!

Kudos for writing a very timely editorial on the status of Indian languages in IT, particularly the Web. It makes me happy to see a magazine of your repute highlighting such important but generally overlooked topics. They are integrally linked with the broad objective of bridging the digital divide, and they have massive economic implications too. You have rightly said that after 60 years of independence, we need to break free from the mentality of linking Indian languages with backwardness.

Also, your analysis of the psychosocial causes and trends behind Indian languages not being as popular on the Net as English is praiseworthy and precise. However, as someone who is integrally related with technical development in Indian languages for past 10 years, I beg to differ on a few counts. Development in Indian languages has taken a fast pace following introduction of Unicode, and you would be happy to know that Hindi and other Indian languages are making steady progress in almost all major directions as far as IT is concerned. I am leading the Web development cell for the World Hindi Conference, to be organised by the Ministry of External Affairs in New York from July 13 to 15, and we were pleasantly surprised to receive more than 50 per cent of the participation requests (online forms) in Hindi!

Indian language portals are getting popular fast. We at Prabhasakshi.com (a Hindi portal, which I edit) have registered a whopping figure of 8.5 lakh hits on May 11 last (the day the UP election results were declared). Our average daily hits are in the range of 3.7 lakh.

During the past five years, path-breaking work has been done in Indian languages, particularly in important fields including operating systems, typing systems, Web portals, Web sites, blogs, podcasting, search, mail, discussion Forums, mailing lists, education, and GUIs.

In fact, scope of this topic is very wide and many interesting articles could be written on various aspects of IT in Indian languages.

Balendu Sharma Dadhich
Via e-mail

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH